

Vira Kasprova

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

AI safety and oversight of LLM agents: whether an agent's completion report matches its execution log, how the report changes with the reporting request, with stakes, and with training pressure (task-reward RL, monitor penalties), and how much log evidence a monitor needs to recover what reports omit. Related interests include error propagation through handoffs, memory, and multi-agent systems, sycophancy and agreement bias, and abstention in tool-using agents.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign <i>Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science, advised by Dr. Varun Chandrasekaran</i>	August 2025 – May 2030 GPA: 4.0/4.0
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign <i>Bachelor of Science in Computer Science</i>	August 2023 – May 2025 GPA: 3.83/4.0
University of Illinois at Chicago <i>Bachelor of Science in Data Science (Transferred to UIUC)</i>	August 2021 – May 2023

PUBLICATIONS

- Too Polite to Disagree: Understanding Sycophancy Propagation in Multi-Agent Systems** 2026
- **Vira Kasprova***, Amruta Parulekar*, Abdulrahman AlRabah*, Krishna Agaram*, Ritwik Garg, Sagar Jha, Nimet Beyza Bozdog, Dilek Hakkani-Tür. *Proceedings of the 27th Annual Meeting of the Special Interest Group on Discourse and Dialogue (SIGDIAL 2026)*, pages 795–814. Association for Computational Linguistics. aclanthology.org/2026.sigdial-1.56 (*equal contribution)
- AgentAbstain: Do LLM Agents Know When Not to Act?** 2026
- Xun Liu[†], Yi Evie Zhang[†], **Vira Kasprova***, Parisa Rabbani*, Pardis Sadat Zahraei*, Tianyu Zhang*, Ali Ebrahimpour-Boroojeny, Varun Chandrasekaran. *40th Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2026)*, Evaluations and Datasets Track (**Oral**, top 0.4%). [arXiv:2607.10059](https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.10059) ([†]project lead; *equal contribution, alphabetical)

PREPRINTS AND UNDER REVIEW

- How Evaluation Choices Change What Coding Agents Report** 2026
- **Vira Kasprova**, Varun Chandrasekaran. *Submitted to the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2027)*. Basis of the proposed project.
- Sycophancy in Language Models: A Survey Across Behaviors and Topologies** 2026
- **Vira Kasprova**, Jingrui He, Dilek Hakkani-Tür, Volodymyr Kindratenko. *Under review at ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR)*. Preprint: [doi:10.5281/zenodo.21347166](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21347166)

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- AI Safety Research Fellow** June 2026 – August 2026
XLab (Existential Risk Laboratory), The University of Chicago Chicago, IL
- Selected for the XLab Summer Research Fellowship, funded by the Berkeley Existential Risk Initiative (BERI)
 - Developed a benchmark that measures what LLM agent reports omit about the actions the agent actually took, in a financial tool-use environment (FinVault)
 - Compared monitors with four levels of access (report only, tool names, tool arguments, tool results) and identified two recurring report failure modes: omission and reference recomposition
 - **Presented** final results at the XLab Summer Fellowship closing session (August 2026)

Teaching Assistant, CS 440: Artificial Intelligence

August 2026 – Present

Siebel School of Computing and Data Science, UIUC

Urbana, IL

- Hold weekly office hours, grade programming assignments and exams, and improve assignments for a class of 90+ students

Full-stack Developer

September 2024 – May 2025

National Center for Supercomputing Applications (NCSA)

Urbana, IL

- Enabled chatbot administrators to analyze user behavior across 8 key metrics by developing interactive dashboards with React and TypeScript, improving data accessibility and actionable insights
- Reduced database query execution time by creating a denormalized table with aggregated data. Implemented triggers to keep data consistent on updates

Data Science Research Assistant

May 2024 – September 2024

National Center for Supercomputing Applications (NCSA)

Urbana, IL

- Categorized unique clusters by implementing k-means and hierarchical clustering, complemented by manual review to refine accuracy and ensure relevance
- **Presented** project titled *Enhancing Response Accuracy of an LLM-Based Teaching Assistant Tool* at the 2024 Summer STEM Career Exploration & Symposium, held at UIUC

Data Science Research Assistant

June 2023 – July 2023

The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

- Revealed a 20% disparity in regional eye-care service availability through geospatial analysis using GeoPandas, regular and Multiscale Geographically Weighted Regression (GWR and MGWR) to identify spatial patterns
- Delivered actionable insights to a nonprofit organization for targeted community interventions by developing an interactive dashboard to visualize regression results

Machine Learning Intern

May 2023

Illinois Department of Transportation

Chicago, IL

- Achieved 92% accuracy in real-time detection and blurring of residential buildings using YOLOv8 models
- **Presented** project titled *Real-Time Object Detection for Enhanced Transportation Safety* to Illinois Department of Transportation leadership, showcasing YOLOv8 model outcomes and safety implications

TECHNICAL SKILLS

LLM/Agents: PyTorch, Transformers (HF), vLLM, MCP, OpenRouter, LLM-judge evaluation with human audits

Agent Evaluation: sandboxed agent harnesses, execution-log instrumentation, monitor evaluation, pre-set thresholds

Languages: Python, C++, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), R

Data/Web: Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, scikit-learn; Flask, React

Infrastructure: HPC clusters, Docker, Weights & Biases, Git, Google Cloud Platform

AWARDS AND HONORS

Cozad New Venture Competition

April 2026

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

- Monetary prize for RxRobotics, a medtech venture developing multimodal intraoperative imaging modules for surgical robots

Duncan H. Lawrie Leadership Award

May 2025

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

- This award is given to a student showing superior qualities of leadership and good citizenship